

THE PLATES of DANA Chapter 2025

Dana and Shannon Gorbahn Family - Christmas & History Letter

Hey Family and Friends,

Christmas is finally here, and we hope your holidays are packed with fun, good times, and a bit of a break! While we love the lights and the cheer, this season always reminds us that everything good in our lives comes back to the birth and life of our Savior, Jesus Christ. We feel so much love and gratitude for Him.

Now, we're excited to officially present this year's letter! Announcing the release of THE PLATES OF DANA: 2025 EDITION! This is our annual way of catching you up on what we've been up to. It's been a busy and good year for us, and we're happy to share the highlights. Wishing you all a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year!



Jadyn: Hey everyone! Another year that's flown right by and another few changes have happened!

The biggest change in my life would be in August, Louie passed away. He unknowingly had a cancer mass that had erupted and he began to internally bleed, he wasn't in pain just discomfort but we had no choice but to put him down. For almost 11 years my whole world revolved around Louie, he was my whole life and best friend so losing him has been extremely hard. Having some new

found freedom was nice for sometime I will admit but it didn't last long cause I ended up getting a puppy in November. Her name is Winnie-Rue and she's brought me so much happiness but also so much stress, I'm not gonna lie. It's been quite the adjustment but I know it's all going to be worth it.

I'm sadly no longer nannying but luckily I got hired by Kaleb to work at Lynx Ridge in the proshop for the summer and fall which was such a great experience! It was so nice to be around new people, make new friends, see Kaleb just about everyday and my favourite would be when Lauren and the nieces would surprise me there. And I will be back at lynx next season!

Somethings I did this year was I got to see a few friends! My friend Mikayla drove here to go to a concert and she surprised me with our friend Liz. I visited Megan in Vanderhoof to go wedding dress shopping and we found the one. And I flew to Victoria to see my other Megan, Taaron and also Mikayla. I'm so thankful for these chances to spend time with all these people. It was also SO cool to see everyone at this years family reunion! Haven't seen some of you in so long! I wish you all an amazing Christmas and a happy new year♥♥ -Jadyn





Kaleb: Merry Christmas Family and Friends!

When I wrote to you last year, I said it had been the best year yet. Thankfully, that trend continues, because 2025 was even better.

I began the year in my new role as Head Professional at Lynx Ridge. I feel incredibly blessed to have found a place that trusted me with running the business despite my limited experience on that side of things. While there were certainly moments of stress and frustration, I never once didn't enjoy going to work. I was also so happy to have Jadyn working for me this summer. She played a huge role in the success of the year with her commitment to both me and the club. I'm grateful she was able to come out, and I'm hoping she agrees to work for her older brother again next year.

At the beginning of April, we were beyond grateful for my parents help in purchasing a new home. The house has been wonderful, and I've enjoyed

working on the lawn and even building a skating rink in the backyard for this winter. The extra space was much needed, because on April 8th, Lauren and I were blessed with another child, Eden Rebekah Gorbahn. Somehow, she has been an even easier baby than Sarah was. Early on, Eden struggled to gain weight, but Lauren, being the amazing mother she is, took such wonderful care of her. Eden is now growing healthy and strong.

Sarah continues to be a joy every single day. She is so smart, dare I say smarter than the average baby? She communicates incredibly well, is so polite, and has such a big personality that Lauren and I can't help but laugh every day.

Lauren is doing wonderfully. I knew she was a great mother before

this year, but watching her juggle two children under two while I was busy working most of the summer has been truly amazing. I can't begin to express how blessed I am that God brought her into my life.

Lauren and I continue to enjoy each day together, and we've both grown significantly in our faith over the past year by reading our scriptures each night. I've never felt stronger in my relationship with God, and this year has truly propelled that forward.

Golf-wise, I continue to play tournaments and had some good results this year. It's definitely been an adjustment not being able to practice or play as much as I once did, but over the summer I traveled to Montreal for the PGA of Canada Championship, where I played very well and finished in the top five nationally. I'm hoping to earn a win somewhere next year.





Once the golf course closed, Lauren and I took a couple of trips with the girls. We went to Puerto Vallarta at the beginning of November, and just recently returned from Cancun, where I was playing in a tournament. Both of my parents came along, my dad caddied for me, and my mom helped Lauren with the girls. It was a good thing they were there, as Lauren was sick for the entire trip and we ended up visiting the hospital in Cancun. Thankfully, we made it home safely, Lauren has had more tests done, and she is beginning to recover.

We are so grateful to have our family close by.

Sunday dinners at my parents house are something we truly cherish, and having a handyman and babysitter nearby doesn't hurt either. I love my parents so much, and having them so close to us and the girls has been a dream come true.

We're now off to Florida to spend Christmas with Lauren's family, which is especially exciting since Lauren's mom hasn't yet had the chance to meet Eden.

Wishing you all a Merry Christmas and a blessed New Year.

Taaron: Hello Family and Friends! I hope you all had an amazing year! I know I did!

In January, I released my first movie! It was a stand up comedy special and documentary I made with a Victoria comedian called "Evan Mumford Burns Everything". We even did a big screening that sold out and was very exciting! It has since reached over 27K views on YouTube! I'm very proud of it and hope to continue directing and filming side projects with all the talented people in Victoria.

In June, I was able to sneak over to Calgary and, with the help of Kaleb and Mom, I surprised my Dad for his birthday on the golf course! It's been awesome having my family in Calgary because it makes it so much easier for me to go and visit them!

Over this past year, I got even more entrenched with the improv and comedy scene in Victoria. Not only have I been doing classes every week, but have also had the opportunity to perform in many improv comedy shows now. It's a ton of fun and I really enjoy going back to performing. A big group of us also took a weekend trip together to Vancouver where we got to watch shows, take workshops and perform! I've also dipped my toes into producing a stand up comedy showcase and am excited to do more shows around Victoria and beyond in 2026!

I hope you all have a wonderful holiday!





Kai: Merry Christmas! I hope you're all doing well and enjoying the holiday season.

This past year went by so fast and kept me busy—especially with my job as a server, juggling long shifts and lots of steps. It's been tiring at times, but also rewarding and full of laughs and plenty of stories.

I'm so thankful for each of you and for the love and support you've given me throughout the year. I hope your holidays are filled with good food, cozy moments, and time with the people you love most. Wishing you a very Merry Christmas and a happy, healthy New Year!

Shannon: It has been such a great year I have loved our move to Airdrie so much and have settled in nicely. It now feels like home. It is so wonderful to be nice and close to those two grand babies. They bring so much joy. I have continued to teach yoga at the church to a wonderful group of ladies who really appreciate it and I will continue in the new year adding an extra class. I have a new

calling at church (Relief Society President) that keeps me just busy enough to feel useful. The highlight of the year was Our trip to Utah for Micah's wedding and then touring around some of the national parks on our E-bikes, they are so much fun. Wishing you all a very Merry Christmas we love you and think of you often!

Dana: This was the year I really settled into retirement, and honestly, I'm loving it. My official job is now full-time user of the indoor golf simulator, which I use almost daily - I'm getting my money's worth! Speaking of golf, I've enjoyed many rounds with my friend Rick Vermunt (still undefeated against him on the course and the simulator, by the way). I got super eyesight via a refractive lens exchange on both eyes. It worked

- I can see every speck of dust now - but the whole healing and adjustment process took way too long! I spend a lot of time on the court with basketball officiating, which I really enjoy. Off the court, I'm still enjoying my time as a Young Men's Advisor - we even produced the "Best Picture" in



our local Film Festival! The golf season officially kicked off with an epic trip. I went to Myrtle Beach with Kaleb, playing two rounds a day. Immediately after that, I flew down to Arizona to meet my brother Luke and his boys (Travis and Jared) for more golf. Every single one of them got ridiculously sick, but somehow, my old, beaten-up body escaped the plague. The back-to-back golf was worth the exhaustion! We had a fantastic visit when John and Marinda came to our place to visit my mom. Shortly after was my birthday. Best one ever! Taaron completely surprised me by showing up on the tee box for a round of golf – everyone (surprisingly Shannon) kept that secret perfectly! Plus, I got to spend some special one-on-one time with each of the kids that weekend. I again, worked as a Golf Marshal for Kaleb at his course, and got to caddy for him a few times through the year. In early July, Shannon and I took off on my first all-inclusive in Jamaica. It wasn't all we had





hoped for (the food was poor), but thanks to my sister Veronica for watching Mom, we did enjoy having a cabaña on the beach every day and taking a beautiful day trip to the Blue Hole. Once we got back from that trip, our house immediately became packed! We hosted 46 family members for a mini-reunion. It was great to see so many of the family! Later in the summer, I went to the Kootenays for another golf trip with Luke, his boys, and their friends - lots of fun and great golfing and great courses. I

also had the privilege of caddying for Kaleb in Montreal for the PGA of Canada Championships, where he played extremely well (T4). We squeezed in a professional tennis match and a taping of Gerry Dee's Netflix special! The biggest golf highlight came near the end of the summer: I beat Kaleb in a round of golf (which hasn't happened since he was nineteen!). I'm pretty sure that means he owes me a golf vacation, right? For our anniversary, I bought us ebikes, and we have had so much fun with them, especially going for rides in the Banff area. I traveled to PG for a Charity Golf tournament, which turned into something like a high school reunion with my friends and where I got to reconnect with my best friend after so so many years (37 years). We had

Thanksgiving, hosting many of Shannon's family who came to visit us. Around that time, I won consecutive weeks in both the Church's Chili contest AND the Stake's Salsa contest. A major adventure came when Heidi came to take care of Mom so we could go down to Provo Utah to my nephew Micah's wedding. It was wonderful to witness and see many of my family. We took the ebikes with us and then traveled around Utah and Idaho to National Parks and visited various Temples—it was such a great trip and something new for us! Such beautiful places in this world! After that big trip, I decided to get serious about my health. I've been eating right and exercising every day I can/should. I'm really liking the results, and it's partly to help with my selection for basketball officiating, since the main feedback was needing a more athletic look. Look out, world, the new, athletic-looking Dana is coming for those selection spots! We just recently came back from Cancun, where we helped Lauren and Kaleb with the kids, and I got to caddy for Kaleb again. I sure enjoy doing that! (And again, Heidi came to take care of Mom - thank you!)



With the steady flow of visitors coming to see my mom, our household has been stretched in new ways, and we are trying to accommodate and manage it. We have been so blessed to be in Airdrie

- to be close to our children (minus Taaron, but we see him more than ever!) and, most importantly, we are close enough to love and spoil our little grandchildren. And of course, my little guy, Oliver the dog, is still my absolutely most favourite little guy - he and I will do anything we can together.

We are so grateful for each of you. Wishing you a truly Christmas and New Year!





Oma: Hi dear friend and family. It's Christmas time and I think of all of you all often. You are dear to me and always have been. I want you to know that I love you and I wish you a very very wonderful and healthy Christmas. I hope that you know who you are and how dear you are to so many people; to me. I love you and I send you my very best wishes and hope you will enjoy each other this season and throughout the coming year. I love you. Bye.



We love you all and wish the very best for you, always! With all our Love - Dana, Shannon, Kai, Taaron, Kaleb, Lauren, Sarah (Noodle), Eden, Jaddy, Louie (in memory), Oliver, Kali, Winnie-Rue, and OMA!